

Word family: **behind / behinds**

Base word: behind

Part of speech: mainly **preposition** and **adverb**, also **noun** and occasionally **adjective**

Related forms / extensions:

* **behind** (prep./adv.) — 在.....後面；落後；遲於；支持；作為背後原因

* **behind** (n., informal) — 臀部

* **behind the scenes** — 幕後

* **behind someone's back** — 背着某人；瞞着某人

* **behind schedule** — 進度落後

* **behind on payments/work** — 欠交；落後

* **leave behind** — 留下；拋下

* **fall behind** — 落後

* **get behind** — 落後；支持

* **be behind something** — 是.....背後原因 / 策劃者

* **the meaning/reason/sincerity behind something** — 某事背後的意思 / 原因 / 真誠

Meaning in this passage

> What stayed with me was not just the apology itself, but the sincerity **behind it**.

Here, **behind it** is figurative.

It means:

underlying it; forming the real feeling, intention, or motivation beneath the visible apology — 在它背後；作為其內在原因 / 真意

The speaker cared not only about the words “I’m sorry,” but about the genuine feeling that motivated those words.

中文翻譯：

讓我一直記得的，不只是那一句道歉本身，而是它**背後的真誠**。

So here:

behind something = 藏在表面行為、說話或事件背後的原因、動機、感情或意義

1. **behind** (位置：在.....後面) — 在.....後面

This is the core spatial sense.

Practice 1

> Kevin was standing **behind me**.

Kevin 站在我**後面**。

Practice 2

> The car is parked **behind the building**.

汽車停在大樓**後面**。

Practice 3

> She hid **behind the door**.

她躲在門**後面**。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind = 位於某人或某物的後方

2. **behind** (在後方移動 / 跟在後面) — 在後面；跟在後面

Practice 1

> I walked ahead while Kevin followed **behind**.

我走在前面，Kevin 跟在**後面**。

Practice 2

> The child ran after her mother from **behind**.

孩子從**後面**跑去追媽媽。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind = in or toward a position at the back

3. **behind someone in a queue / line** — 排在某人後面

Practice 1

> I was standing **behind Kevin in the queue**.

我排在 Kevin 後面。

Practice 2

> There were several people **behind us**.

我們後面還有幾個人。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind someone = 在排列、隊伍或位置上位於某人之後

4. **behind (落後於 ; 比不上)** — 落後

A major figurative extension.

Practice 1

> Our team is **behind** by two points.

我們的隊伍落後兩分。

Practice 2

> The company is **behind its competitors** in technology.

公司在科技方面落後於競爭對手。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind = 在進度、分數、能力或發展上落後於別人

5. **fall behind** — 落後 ; 跟不上

Practice 1

> I missed several classes and **fell behind**.

我缺了幾堂課，所以**落後了**。

Practice 2

> Don't let the project **fall behind**.

不要讓項目**進度落後**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fall behind = 原本跟得上，但之後逐漸落後於應有進度或別人****

6. ****be behind in work / study — 工作 / 學習進度落後****

Practice 1

> I'm **behind in my coursework**.

我的課業**進度落後**。

Practice 2

> He is several chapters **behind**.

他的進度**落後了幾章**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be behind in X = 在 X 的進度上未達到應有水平****

7. ****behind schedule — 進度落後；比原定時間遲****

A very important fixed phrase.

Practice 1

> The project is **behind schedule**.

項目**進度落後**。

Practice 2

> We are two days **behind schedule**.

我們比原定進度**遲了兩天**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****behind schedule = 實際進度比原定計劃慢****

8. ****behind time — 遲了；進度落後****

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> We're running ****behind time****.

我們的進度**遲了**。

Practice 2

> The meeting started ****behind time****.

會議比原定時間**遲開始**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****behind time = 比原定時間遲****

9. ****behind on something — 欠着；未完成****

Practice 1

> I'm ****behind on my work****.

我的工作**積壓了 / 未完成**。

Practice 2

> He is ****behind on his payments****.

他的付款**拖欠了**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****behind on X = 未能按時完成、支付或處理 X****

10. **behind on payments / rent** — 欠款；欠租

Practice 1

> They are two months **behind on rent**.

他們已經欠了兩個月租金。

Practice 2

> She fell **behind on her loan payments**.

她的貸款還款開始拖欠。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind on payments = 沒有按原定日期支付應付款項

11. **behind** (晚於；落後於某時間點) — 遲於

Practice 1

> We're running five minutes **behind**.

我們遲了五分鐘。

Practice 2

> The train is ten minutes **behind**.

火車晚了十分鐘。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind = 比預定或預期時間遲

12. **behind something** (背後原因 / 動機) — 在.....背後；是其原因

This is the exact semantic branch used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I remembered the sincerity **behind the apology**.

我記得那次道歉**背後的真誠**。

Practice 2

> What was the reason **behind his decision**?

他這個決定**背後的原因**是甚麼？

Practice 3

> I wanted to understand the thinking **behind the plan**.

我了解這個計劃**背後的思路**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****behind X = 構成 X 內在原因、動機、想法或感情的東西****

13. ****the reason behind something — 某事背後的原因****

Practice 1

> Nobody knew the reason **behind the change**.

沒有人知道這項改變**背後的原因**。

Practice 2

> Stress was one reason **behind his reaction**.

壓力是他那個反應**背後的其中一個原因**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reason behind X = 導致 X 發生的內在原因****

14. ****the idea / thinking behind something — 某事背後的理念 / 思路****

Practice 1

> What's the idea **behind this design**?

這個設計**背後的理念**是甚麼？

Practice 2

> She explained the thinking **behind the decision**.

她解釋了該決定**背後的思路**。

MCQ-ready definition:

idea/thinking behind X = X 所根據的理念、推理或思考方式

15. **the meaning behind something — 某事背後的含意**

Practice 1

> I didn't understand the meaning **behind his words**.

我不明白他那番話**背後的含意**。

Practice 2

> The symbol has a deeper meaning **behind it**.

這個符號**背後**有更深層的含意。

MCQ-ready definition:

meaning behind X = X 表面之外更深一層的含意

16. **the emotion / sincerity behind something — 某事背後的感情 / 真誠**

Practice 1

> I could feel the emotion **behind her words**.

我能感受到她說話**背後的感情**。

Practice 2

> The sincerity **behind his apology** mattered more than the exact wording.

他道歉**背後的真誠**比具體措辭更重要。

MCQ-ready definition:

****emotion/sincerity behind X = 推動 X 或透過 X 表達出來的內在感情 / 真心****

17. ****be behind something (是.....的幕後策劃者 / 原因) — 是.....背後的人 / 力量****

A major separate figurative use.

Practice 1

> Who was ****behind the campaign****?

是誰在****幕後策劃這場活動****？

Practice 2

> Investigators wanted to know who was ****behind the scheme****.

調查人員想知道是誰在****背後策劃這個計劃****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be behind X = 是造成、組織或策劃 X 的人或力量****

18. ****what's behind something? — 甚麼導致.....？背後是甚麼？****

Practice 1

> What's ****behind the sudden change****?

這次突然改變****背後的原因是甚麼****？

Practice 2

> Researchers are trying to find out what's ****behind the problem****.

研究人員正嘗試找出問題****背後的原因****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****what's behind X? = 詢問造成 X 的真正原因、動機或機制****

19. ****behind someone (支持某人) — 支持；作後盾****

Another major figurative sense.

Practice 1

> The whole team is **behind you**.

整個團隊都**支持你**。

Practice 2

> Her family stood **behind her** throughout the difficult period.

她的家人在困難期間一直**支持她**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be behind someone = 支持某人及其行動、決定或目標

20. **get behind someone / something — 支持某人 / 某事**

Practice 1

> We all need to **get behind the project**.

我們都需要**支持這個項目**。

Practice 2

> The community **got behind the campaign**.

社區開始全力**支持這場活動**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get behind X = 開始積極支持 X

21. **behind the scenes — 幕後；私下運作**

A very common idiom.

Practice 1

> A lot of work happens **behind the scenes**.

很多工作都在**幕後**進行。

Practice 2

> She played an important role **behind the scenes**.

她在**幕後**扮演重要角色。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind the scenes = 在公眾看不到的地方進行，尤其指幕後準備或運作

22. **behind someone's back — 背着某人；瞞着某人**

Practice 1

> They discussed me **behind my back**.

他們**背着我**談論我。

Practice 2

> Don't make decisions **behind her back**.

不要**瞞着她**作決定。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind someone's back = 在某人不知道或不在場時秘密做某事

23. **go behind someone's back — 繞過某人暗中做事**

Practice 1

> He **went behind my back** and changed the plan.

他**背着我**改了計劃。

Practice 2

> She felt betrayed because they had **gone behind her back**.

他們**瞞着她行事**，令她覺得被背叛。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****go behind someone's back = 刻意瞞着某人做他可能不會同意的事****

24. ****leave something behind (遺留) — 留下 ; 忘記帶走****

Practice 1

> I ****left my phone behind****.

我****忘了帶走電話****。

Practice 2

> Don't ****leave anything behind****.

不要****遺下任何東西****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave X behind = 離開時沒有帶走 X , 使它留在原來地方****

25. ****leave someone behind — 把某人留在後面 / 拋下****

Practice 1

> Wait! Don't ****leave me behind****.

等等！不要****把我丟在後面****。

Practice 2

> The group moved too quickly and ****left him behind****.

小組走得太快，把他****落在後面****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave someone behind = 繼續向前而讓某人留在後面，或不再帶着 / 照顧對方****

26. ****leave the past behind — 放下過去****

Figurative.

Practice 1

> She wanted to **leave the past behind**.

她想**放下過去**。

Practice 2

> It's time to **leave the argument behind** and move on.

是時候**放下那場爭吵**，繼續向前。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave X behind = figurative: 不再讓過去的事情影響自己，繼續前進****

27. **leave a legacy / something behind — 留下遺產 / 影響**

Practice 1

> He **left behind** a large collection of writings.

他**留下了**大量著作。

Practice 2

> The project **left behind** a useful system for future students.

項目為後來的學生**留下了**一套有用系統。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave X behind = 離開、死亡或結束後，仍有 X 留存****

28. **behind closed doors — 閉門進行；秘密進行**

Practice 1

> The discussion took place **behind closed doors**.

討論以**閉門方式**進行。

Practice 2

> They reached the agreement **behind closed doors**.

他們在**非公開情況下**達成協議。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind closed doors = 不向公眾開放、私下秘密進行

29. **behind bars** — 身陷囹圄；在監獄中

Practice 1

> He spent several years **behind bars**.

他在**監獄裏**度過了幾年。

Practice 2

> The criminal was finally put **behind bars**.

罪犯終於被**關進監獄**。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind bars = in prison

中文：

在監獄中；服刑

30. **behind the wheel** — 在駕駛；掌舵

Practice 1

> Don't use your phone when you're **behind the wheel**.

駕駛時不要使用電話。

Practice 2

> She feels confident **behind the wheel**.

她**駕車時**很有自信。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****behind the wheel = 正在駕駛車輛****

31. ****behind the times — 落伍；跟不上時代****

Practice 1

> Their system is badly ****behind the times****.

他們的系統非常****落伍****。

Practice 2

> That attitude feels ****behind the times****.

那種態度令人覺得****跟不上時代****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****behind the times = 思想、技術或做法已經過時，不符合現代標準****

32. ****put something behind you — 放下不愉快的事情****

Practice 1

> I wanted to ****put the misunderstanding behind me****.

我想****放下那場誤會****。

Practice 2

> They apologized and decided to ****put the incident behind them****.

他們道歉後決定****不再糾纏那件事****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****put X behind you = 接受 X 已經過去，不再讓它影響自己****

33. ****behind (noun, informal : 臀部) — 屁股；臀部****

Informal and often humorous/polite.

Practice 1

> Sit down on your **behind**.

坐下來，把你的**屁股**坐好。

Practice 2

> He fell on his **behind**.

他跌坐在**屁股**上。

MCQ-ready definition:

behind = informal, mildly humorous: the buttocks

This is much less relevant to your passage but is a real everyday sense.

Important distinction 1: **behind vs after**

behind

usually spatial position or figurative lag.

after

usually time/order or following someone.

> behind the building

> 大樓後面

> after lunch

> 午飯後

In some movement contexts they overlap:

> run after someone

> 追某人

not usually:

> *run behind someone* if you mean chase them.

Important distinction 2: ****behind vs at the back of****

****behind the car****

outside/positioned to its rear.

****at the back of the car****

can mean the rear part of the car, possibly inside.

So location nuance matters.

Important distinction 3: ****behind schedule vs late****

****late****

broad: later than expected.

****behind schedule****

specifically progress is slower than planned.

> The train is late.

火車晚點。

> The project is behind schedule.

項目進度落後。

Important distinction 4: ****behind vs fall behind****

****be behind****

state.

> I'm behind in my work.

我工作進度落後。

fall behind

change into that state.

> I fell behind after being sick.

生病後我開始跟不上進度。

Important distinction 5: **behind on vs behind in**

behind on

often unfinished obligations:

- * payments
- * rent
- * bills
- * work

behind in

often progress in a field:

- * schoolwork
- * reading
- * development

There is overlap, but these are useful tendencies.

Important distinction 6: **behind something = physically behind vs cause behind**

Physical

> behind the door

門後面

Figurative cause

> reason behind the decision

決定背後的原因

Same spatial metaphor extended to abstract causes.

Important distinction 7: ****behind an action vs behind a person****

****behind an action****

may mean cause/organizer:

> Who is behind this plan?

誰策劃這個計劃？

****behind a person****

may mean physical position or support:

> I'm behind you.

我在你後面 / 我支持你。

Context is essential.

Important distinction 8: ****behind someone = support vs follow****

Support

> We're behind you.

我們支持你。

Physical

> We're walking behind you.

我們走在你後面。

The verb/context disambiguates.

Important distinction 9: ****behind the scenes vs secretly****

behind the scenes

not visible publicly; often perfectly legitimate.

secretly

deliberately kept hidden.

A lot of normal preparation happens behind the scenes without being secretive.

Important distinction 10: **behind someone's back vs behind the scenes**

behind someone's back

usually negative: without that person's knowledge.

behind the scenes

neutral: not visible to the public.

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction 11: **leave behind literal vs figurative**

Literal

> leave your bag behind

遺下袋

Person

> leave someone behind

把某人落在後面

Figurative

> leave the past behind

放下過去

Legacy

> leave something behind

留下某種成果 / 遺產

A highly productive construction.

Important distinction 12: **put it behind you vs leave it behind**

Both can mean move on emotionally.

put it behind you

especially deliberate decision to stop dwelling on it.

leave it behind

often emphasizes moving away from the past.

Important distinction 13: **behind bars is fixed**

It does not simply mean standing behind any bars.

As an idiom:

behind bars = in prison

Important distinction 14: **behind the wheel**

Literal image:

> sitting behind the steering wheel

Lexicalized meaning:

driving

It can also figuratively suggest being in charge, though **at the wheel** is more common for that

broader leadership metaphor.

Important distinction 15: **behind the times vs behind schedule**

behind schedule

late in a specific plan.

behind the times

old-fashioned / outdated.

> project behind schedule

> 進度落後

> technology behind the times

> 技術落伍

Important distinction 16: **sincerity behind it**

In your passage, **behind** does not mean:

* physically behind the apology,

* later than the apology,

* supporting the apology.

It means:

the inner quality motivating and giving substance to the apology

This is a classic abstract extension of spatial **behind**.

Family-extension note

Behind has several major modern branches:

1. **physical position**

* behind the door

* behind me

2. **lag / delay**

- * fall behind
- * behind schedule
- * behind on payments

3. **underlying cause / meaning**

- * reason behind
- * meaning behind
- * sincerity behind

4. **responsibility / authorship**

- * who is behind the plan?

5. **support**

- * the team is behind you
- * get behind a project

6. **hidden/private activity**

- * behind the scenes
- * behind someone's back
- * behind closed doors

7. **leaving / moving on**

- * leave behind
- * put behind you

8. **fixed idioms**

- * behind bars
- * behind the wheel
- * behind the times

9. **informal noun**

- * behind = 臀部

The central metaphor is:

**what is physically behind something is less visible → what is figuratively behind something is

its hidden cause, motive, support, or meaning**

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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behind (place)	在.....後面	physical rear position
behind someone in line	排在某人後面	sequence
behind (progress)	落後	lag
fall behind	落後；跟不上	become delayed
behind schedule	進度落後	slower than plan
behind time	遲了	late
behind on payments	欠款	overdue
behind in work	工作進度落後	incomplete progress
behind X (reason)	X 背後	underlying cause
reason behind X	X 背後的原因	cause
meaning behind X	X 背後的含意	deeper meaning
sincerity behind X	X 背後的真誠	underlying feeling
be behind X	是 X 的幕後原因 / 策劃者	responsible for
be behind someone	支持某人	support
get behind X	支持 X	actively support
behind the scenes	幕後	unseen work
behind someone's back	背着某人	without knowledge
behind closed doors	閉門 / 秘密進行	private
leave X behind	留下 / 遺下 X	not take
leave someone behind	把某人落在後面	move on without
leave the past behind	放下過去	move on
put X behind you	放下 X	stop dwelling
behind bars	在監獄中	imprisoned
behind the wheel	駕駛中	driving
behind the times	落伍	outdated
behind (noun)	臀部；屁股	informal body part

For your original sentence

> What stayed with me was not just the apology itself, but the sincerity **behind it**.

Here:

behind it = 存在於道歉表面說話之下、真正推動那次道歉的內在態度**

So the contrast is:

> ****the apology itself****

> = Kevin 實際說出口的道歉

> ****the sincerity behind it****

> = 那些說話背後真正的誠意與真心

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 讓我一直記得的，不只是那一句道歉本身，而是它****背後的真誠****。

For MCQ purposes, the cleanest contextual meaning is:

****behind = underlying; forming the hidden reason, intention, meaning, or feeling behind something — 在.....背後；構成其內在原因 / 動機 / 感情****